

Detailed Itinerary:

Ms Nancy Smith & Ms Andrea Nunnery

Starting in Delhi on 04/01/2023

Ending in Trivandrum on 11/01/2023

Day 1 (Wed 04-Jan-23), Delhi

Arrive in Delhi. You are met on arrival at Delhi International airport and transferred to your hotel. Stay in Colonel's Retreat. Afternoon tour of Old Delhi by Metro & rickshaw.

DELHI

Delhi is practically two cities: New Delhi, the capital of India, and medieval Old Delhi. The old city centres around the Red Fort, which contains opulent palaces and impressive public buildings. Nearby is the magnificent Jama Masjid, India's largest mosque. In New Delhi you can find India Gate - a war memorial arch, the impressive Parliament Building and Rashtrapati Bhawan, the residence of the President. Towards the South are Qutab Minar and Humayun's Tomb, both World Heritage Sites.

COLONEL'S RETREAT

Colonel's Retreat is a very pleasant and homely guest house in the upmarket, tree-lined neighborhood of Defence Colony. The large rooms are comfortable and artistically furnished. Each floor boasts a lovely lounge area with comfortable sofas for relaxing, books to read and borrow, and computers. A private rooftop dining area gives you a lovely view of the city.

HALF-DAY TOUR OF OLD DELHI BY METRO & RICKSHAW

A half-day tour to Old Delhi using the modern Metro and the traditional cycle rickshaw. The Metro brings you to the heart of Old Delhi in just a few minutes, to visit the magnificent Jama Masjid mosque, India's largest. You then use walk and ride cycle rickshaws through the fascinating maze of narrow streets around the main street of Old Delhi, Chandni Chowk, a bustling jumble of craft shops, traders, mosques and temples. At one end of this street is the huge Red Fort, the symbol of Delhi, which contains within it palaces and impressive public buildings. At the other is the colourful and aromatic Spice Market, the roof of which offers great views over Old Delhi. You can also visit the bustling and colourful Sikh Gurdwara. Whilst returning to the hotel by Metro at the end of the tour, you may choose to stop off at Connaught Place to enjoy the many restaurants and more modern shops. Note: We will not be visiting the interior of the Red Fort because on this tour we concentrate on the narrow alleys and atmosphere of Old Delhi. However, you could arrange with your local guide to see the Red Fort at the end of your half-day tour. Please also note that the Red Fort is closed on Mondays and national holidays.

Day 2 (Thu 05-Jan-23), Rishikesh

Departure transfer in Delhi from hotel to railway station where you board the Dehradun Shatabdi Express train to Haridwar (06:50/11:25). On arrival at Haridwar railway station you will be met and transferred to your hotel in Rishikesh (51kms, 02:00hrs). Stay in Dewa Retreat.

RISHIKESH

The River Ganges leaves the Himalayan foothills and enters the plains at Rishikesh. It is therefore an important place to Hindus and for Hindu practices, and so has many temples, ashrams, and yoga institutes. The city itself is busy and congested, but a much more tranquil atmosphere can be found on, and around, the banks of the river. Rishikesh is easily explored on your own, on foot.

DEWA RETREAT

A new, modern hotel close to the River Ganges and the Laxman Jhula bridge. The rooms are large, well furnished, and many have balconies. There is a small garden, a swimming pool, and, best of all, a fabulous organic café, Pure Soul, serving some of the best vegetarian food in Rishikesh. There are free yoga lessons every morning.

Day 3 (Fri 06-Jan-23), Rishikesh

Day at leisure to explore Rishikesh on your own.

Day 4 (Sat 07-Jan-23), Rishikesh

Day at leisure to explore Rishikesh on your own.

Day 5 (Sun 08-Jan-23), Rishikesh

Day at leisure to explore Rishikesh on your own.

Day 6 (Mon 09-Jan-23), Haridwar

Drive to Haridwar (51kms, 02:00hrs). Stay in Devnadi - The Heritage Hotel.

HARIDWAR

Ancient Haridwar is one of the seven holiest places in India, and one of the oldest living cities. It's made up of a fascinating and colourful collection of sadhus (holy men), pundits (priests), pilgrims, guides, and beggars. The heart of the city is Har Ki Pauri, a bathing 'ghat' at the banks of the Ganges, and the lovely, bustling market around it. Every evening, the Ganges comes alive with a magical ceremony, the aarti.

DEVNADI - THE HERITAGE HOTEL

A wonderfully-restored art-deco mansion that once belonged to a princess of Nepal, this is now a small hotel, right on the banks of the Ganges, and a short walk away from Har Ki Pauri, the main ceremonial area. The rooms are highly atmospheric and high-ceilinged, with great views over the river. The hotel has a private bathing ghat, at which they conduct their own aarti ceremony every evening.

Day 7 (Tue 10-Jan-23), Delhi

Departure transfer in Haridwar from hotel to railway station where you board the 12056 NDLS Shatabdi train to Delhi (06:29/11:05). You are met on arrival at Delhi railway station and transferred to your hotel. Stay in Colonel's Retreat.

Day 8 (Wed 11-Jan-23), Trivandrum

Departure transfer in Delhi from hotel to Delhi Domestic airport. Board the Air Vistara UK 895 flight to Trivandrum (08:10/11:25). End of tour.